

A REAL RAILGUN

We don't have a real working light-saber yet, but someone out

there went ahead and built an experimental railgun. If that doesn't ring any bells, you probably don't belong to the golden era of Quake 2. Read on to find out more.
<http://dgit.in/RailgunIRL>

PROJECT WINGS

Google has been thoroughly testing out its drone-delivery service under Project Wing and recently it conducted a dry run where the drone dropped a package and flew off.
<http://dgit.in/GoogWing>

50 SCI-FI MOVIES

We know that you absolutely dig sci-fi movies. For all you film buffs out there, here's a compilation of fifty such flicks that you simply have to watch at least once in your lifetime.
<http://dgit.in/50SciFi>

UBER MAP-MAKING

Uber has unleashed its own line of map-making cars on the

roads in order to improve their maps and optimise driving routes. Uber map-ping vehicle is reminiscent of Google's Street View car's design.
<http://dgit.in/UberMapCar>

8 cool features of the new Chromecast

Google unveiled the second iteration of the Chromecast conveniently called, well, Chromecast. Nevertheless, the device packs an interesting set of features.

– By Sameer Mitha

Launched back in 2013, the original Chromecast was a dream device for those that wanted to stream content from their Android smartphone to their dumb TV. Put simply, this compact HDMI dongle can plug into the back of your TV and you would be able to not only mirror your smartphone's display on the TV but stream movies and music as well. Today we are going to talk about the Second Generation Chromecast which significantly improves on the original. Here is a quick look at eight new features of Google's new HDMI dongle.

HDMI cord sticking out at one end. The new Chromecast is available in three colours – red, black and yellow (Google calls the yellow one lemon). The new device still needs external power but the new design has an attractive change.

Better Wi-Fi

Having used the Chromecast for over a year now, I have never faced any Wi-Fi connectivity issues. The new Chromecast supports 802.11ac over 5Ghz, so it's compatible with all modern state-of-the-art Wi-Fi routers enabling faster and smoother streaming. On the inside, it has three bespoke antennas. To put things into perspective, the first generation Chromecast has only one antenna. Interestingly, the Chromecast team worked with Google's OnHub team to ensure better streaming, and it shows.

It is important to note though that the overall quality depends on two factors. The access points (routers etc.) are always a step ahead of phones, which means that while phones such as the Galaxy S6 and iPhone 6 are compatible with 802.11ac Wi-Fi, some or many others may not be. So, before you complain about your new Chromecast, you should verify if your phone supports that.

Fast Play

If you thought content takes too long to start and stream (and we aren't talking about the bad internet plans in India), then Google



agrees with you. With the new Chromecast, Google has added Fast Play which is Google's version of smart streaming. So if you were watching an episode of the Big Bang Theory, Fast Play will start buffering the next unwatched episode, even before you hit play. Sit back and think of the number of times you have patiently waited for a movie to buffer. As per Google, the movie starts playing 80% faster.

Gaming

Mirroring your Android smartphone to your TV via the original Chromecast wasn't a great experience thanks to lag. What's cool about the new Chromecast is that you can now use your large screen TV as a display and your smartphone becomes a dedicated controller. At the event, Google demonstrated the ability to play Angry Birds Go in multiplayer mode, where two people use their phone as the controller and the TV as a display. This is similar to multiplayer on console. That's impressive. Sure, the graphics can't match

**New Design**

The original Chromecast had a compact design but was inconvenient especially if you were looking to plug in another HDMI device right next to it at the back of your TV. Sure, you can use an HDMI extender, but that just adds to the clutter. The new Chromecast has a circular design with the